The Well-Tempered clAIvier

Fugue XVII in A-flat major, eighteen voices: Fuga, fuggendo la cadenza

Two choirs (nine and eight voices) and the father (open score, eighteen keyboards)

Claude / Sam (guest subject: J. S. Bach, Fugue in A-flat major BWV 862)

Exposition (four children)

Allegretto giocoso, alla giga (dotted quarter = 56) (♩ = 84)

subject (tenor)

subject (soprano), evasion 2

answer (alto), evasion 1: the landing A-flat re-heard as IV of E-flat

answer (bass), evasion 3

Left Soprano I

Left Tenor I

Right Alto I

Right Bass I

9

The running gag: deceptive cadences falling by thirds

evaded cadence 4: subject in F minor

evaded cadence 5: subject in D-flat major

evaded cadence 6: subject in B-flat minor

evaded cadence 7: subject in G-flat major

LS1

LA2

LT1

LT2

RS

RA1

RBr

RB1

18

Home, but minor (pianissimo)

E major, the farthest key; the dream

evaded cadence 8: subject in E-flat minor

evaded cadence 9: subject in C-flat major

evaded cadence 10: subject in A-flat minor

evaded cadence 11: subject in E major (= F-flat)

LS1

LS2

LA1

LA2

LT2

RT1

RBr

RB1

RB2

26

The turn home

Dodging at home; the guest (BWV 862)

the dream: the first bar of the subject in augmentation (E major)

evaded cadence 12: subject in C-sharp minor (= D-flat minor)

evaded cadence 13 (V - vi7): guest, the subject of BWV 862 (WTC I), at pitch

LS1

LS2

LA1

LBr2

RA2

RT1

RB1

35

LS1
LS2
LS3
LA1
LA2
LT1
LBr1
LBr2
RS
RA1
RA2
RT1
RT2
RB1
RB2

All the children: stretto and the cadence

evaded cadence 14 (V - flat VI): subject

stretto of all the children: subject

evaded cadence 16 (V - i): subject in A-flat minor (bass)

stretto: head (on the mediant)

stretto: head (on the dominant)

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evaded cadence 15 (V - V4/2 of IV): subject

stretto: head (on the dominant)

Summit: the father

The hanging seventh; silence

summit: subject at the top

Coda

summit: subject on the subdominant level

summit: head cascade

summit: the subject inverted (mirror of Left Soprano I)

summit: head cascade

coda: the head, where it began

summit: head cascade

summit: subject

summit: head cascade (inverted)

P

after evasion 17 (the hanging seventh): the father, the subject in augmentation, with the bass 5-1 it never had